D.J. PARIS

DON'T TELL BUYERS TO WAIT FOR SPRING THIS YEAR.

Two national reports say the better window is open right now.

D.J. Paris
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RIGHT NOW MAY BE A BETTER TIME TO BUY THAN NEXT SPRING.

Realtor.com and Redfin both say listing prices are already down from the summer peak.

MOST AGENTS WAIT. THE DATA SAYS MOVE NOW.

Realtor.com's 2026 research found listing prices typically fall three and a half percent from their seasonal high by early fall. Redfin's September analysis found early October is typically the best time to find a deal in the Chicago market specifically. A buyer who waits for spring is waiting past the exact window when sellers who listed over the summer are the most open to negotiating.

WHAT TO DO WITH A BUYER WHO SAYS "LET'S JUST WAIT":

1 **Show them the math, not just the advice.**
Listing prices are already down roughly three and a half percent from the summer peak, per Realtor.com.

2 **Get serious buyers touring this month.**
Chicago sellers who listed over the summer are the ones most open to a lower price right now, per Redfin.

3 **Keep the ask small.**
Tour three homes this week. If none fit, wait, but wait with the actual data instead of a guess.

THE TAKEAWAY

THE BEST DEAL OF THE FALL MIGHT ALREADY BE SITTING ON THE MARKET.

Get serious buyers touring now, before the spring crowd shows back up.

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